

GTA SAN ANDREAS STORIES 1987

v3.0.0 • Fan-made installer

*Fan-made tool. Not affiliated with Rockstar Games or Take-Two Interactive.
GTA San Andreas is required and must be legally purchased.*

Introduction

This document is the canonical reference for the **GTA San Andreas Stories 1987 Installer** — a fan-made, open-source-friendly Python tool that builds a fully portable, standalone modded San Andreas install. It is organised in two parts: the first half is a complete credits & attribution list (so everyone who contributed to the mod, its dependencies, and the installer itself gets proper recognition); the second half is a step-by-step fork guide for developers who want to rebuild, modify, or extend the installer when it is eventually released as open source.

If you are an end user, you only need to read the Credits section to understand who built what. If you are a developer planning to fork the project, jump straight to the Fork Guide on page 4. The guide assumes basic familiarity with Python, PySide6 (Qt6), and PyInstaller — it is not a Python tutorial.

Credits & Attribution

GTA San Andreas Stories 1987 — Mod Team

This installer exists only to make it easier to install the **GTA San Andreas Stories 1987** total-conversion mod. All credit for the mod itself belongs to its development team. The official mod website is <https://gtasas.netlify.app/> and the community Discord is <https://discord.gg/t5SjMrAJNh>.

The following contributor list was extracted directly from the mod's official credits page (embedded in the React JS bundle of the site). Every name below has contributed time, talent, or resources to the project.

Lead Team

Name	Role
babamohammed2022	Scripting, In-game Photography, Supervision, Optimization
Abdullah (AdevAbdullah)	Website Design, Models, Suggestions, Programming
FrankoU	Mapping Specialist, Artist, Server Administration, Retexturing, Screenshot Production, Artworks
avixreal	Supervision, Website Assistance, Website Design
The Small Chese	Mission Design, Creative Direction
Armando	Sounds, Retexture, Supervisor, Tester, Screenshots, Missions Designer, Administration, Modding

Contributors

Name	Contribution
Mike	Missions, In-game Photography
JoGamer	Animations, Modelling, Suggestions, Screenshots, Artistic collaboration; fixed radar icons
GTAMissionsCreator	Video Production
Noobshakespeare	Retexturing, Mission Testing, Bug Report
karammii	Billboards Design
Jmanuc	Screenshots, Suggestions, Supervision, Optimization, Artworks, Atmosphere Enhancements, F
Rayane	Suggestions, Supervision
Seve267	Scripting Help, DYOM Modder, Bug Fixer, Miscellaneous
Forge	Scripting Help
Elrico	Mission Testing, Promotional Screenshots, Server Contribution
Reaper	HUD improvements, Weapon Icons, Supervision
Sadie	Supervision
Rule Breakers	Environmental Mapping

Bolszewik	In-game Photography
14todoeltiempodc	Weapon Retextures
NorthStationX	Billboards Design, Logo Creation
FrankoU	Special Mods (Vehicles Parked in Airport LS, Beta Sweet House, and others)
Lost MC Claude	Bug Testing
MAHMOGAMER	Project Supervision
MaxMakoShark	Server Supervision
Tix	Gameplay Testing
Raul	Visual Enhancements, Mission Testing, Storyline Improvements, Video Recording, Supervision
Urafael Games	Coding Expertise and ASI Development
Fikan	Remapping Artist

Special Thanks

Endochronic • SASquad • Yucark • TheMadeMan

Supporting Mods (downloaded by the installer)

The GTA SAS 1987 mod already bundles all required dependencies (per the official site's note: *"GTA San Andreas Stories already includes all required dependencies. The storyline is built on DYOM 8.1, which is already included and fully configured inside the archive."*). The installer offers these as **optional** extras for users who want to update them independently.

Mod	Source	Author	License
CLEO 5	github.com/cleolib/CLEO5	CLEO Library team	BSD 3-Clause
CLEO+	github.com/JuniorDjrr/CLEOPlus	JuniorDjrr	See repo README
NewOpcodes	mixmods.com.br/2020/10/newopcodes-cleo-5-12-pac	DK-12Pac	See MixMods page
DYOM 8.1	Bundled in main mod archive	Dutchy3010 & PatrickW	Free for personal use

Tools & Services Used by the Installer

Service	URL	Used for
GameCopyWorld	gamecopyworld.com	Auto-downloading the HOODLUM v1.0 No-CD patch for users with Steam/SecuROM
LibertyCity.net	libertycity.net	Fallback search when the main mod isn't found on the official gtasas.netlify.app site
MixMods.com.br	mixmods.com.br	Original article pages for CLEO+ and NewOpcodes (Brazilian GTA modding community)
GitHub	github.com	Source hosting for CLEO 5, CLEO+, and the official GTA SAS 1987 website repo.
MediaFire	mediafire.com	Hosts the official GTA SAS 1987 main mod archive (GTA_SAS_june_2026.rar).
Pricedown BI font	dafont.com/pricedown.font	The actual GTA logo typeface by Typodermic Fonts Inc. Free for commercial use.
VCS carcols.dat palette	gta.fandom.com/wiki/Carcols.dat/GTA_VCS_palette	GTA VCS palette inspiration (dark greens preferred for legibility).

Python Dependencies

The installer is built on the following open-source Python libraries. Each is licensed under a permissive open-source license (MIT, Apache 2.0, BSD, LGPL, or ISC).

Library	Author	License
PySide6 (Qt6)	The Qt Company	LGPL v3

requests	Kenneth Reitz	Apache 2.0
beautifulsoup4	Leonard Richardson	MIT
py7zr	Hiroshi Miura	LGPL-3.0
rarfile	Marko Kreen	ISC
psutil	Giampaolo Rodola	BSD 3-Clause
PyInstaller	PyInstaller team	GPL

Legal Disclaimer

This installer is a **fan-made tool** and is **not affiliated with, endorsed by, or sponsored by** Rockstar Games, Take-Two Interactive, or any of the mod authors listed above.

GTA San Andreas is a trademark of Rockstar Games / Take-Two Interactive. You must own a legal copy of the game to use this installer. **GTA San Andreas Stories 1987** is the property of its respective authors (see Mod Team credits above). **Pricedown BI** font is free for commercial use under the Typodermic Fonts license (bundled).

The installer does **not** distribute the game itself, the mod, or any copyrighted assets — it only downloads them from the official sources listed above at install time. The shared cache (**cache/** folder next to the installer) stores downloaded files locally for re-use; delete this folder to fully uninstall.

If you are a copyright holder and believe any part of this installer infringes your rights, please open an issue on the project repository and we will address it promptly.

Fork Guide — How to Rebuild the Installer

This section is for developers who want to fork, modify, or extend the installer when it is released as open source. It walks through the project structure, the data flow, every module's responsibility, and the build process. By the end you should be able to add a new mod source, a new wizard page, or a new download resolver without breaking existing functionality.

1. Project Layout

The project follows a standard Python package layout. The entry point is `installer.py` at the root. All application code lives in the `src/` package, with UI code in `src/ui/`. Data files (exe hash table) live in `data/`. Splash images live in `src/ui/splash/`. The Pricedown font lives in `fonts/`.

`installer.py` – application entry point. Sets up logging, creates the `QApplication`, applies the theme, and shows the wizard. Keep this file thin – all real logic is in `src/`.

`src/config.py` – central configuration. All mod URLs, version constants, cache paths, and the `ModSource` dataclass live here. To add a new mod, you add a new `ModSource` entry to `PREREQUISITE_MODS` or `MAIN_MOD`. The order field determines install order.

`src/cache.py` – shared cache manager. Caches downloaded archives (by SHA-1 of URL) and extracted mod folders in a `cache/` folder next to the installer. Re-runs hit the cache instead of re-downloading.

`src/sa_detector.py` – locates the user's GTA San Andreas install via Windows registry, Steam libraryfolders.vdf, and common install paths. Falls back to manual browse.

`src/sa_hashes.py` – SHA-1 hash + file-size detection of `gta_sa.exe` against `data/exe_hashes.json`. Used to determine if the exe is v1.0 (mod-compatible) or needs downgrade.

`src/scrapper.py` – scrapes `gtasas.netlify.app` for the live mod URL list. The site is a React SPA, so the scraper fetches the JS bundle and regex-extracts download URLs. Falls back to `LibertyCity.net` search if the main mod isn't on the official site.

`src/downloader.py` – HTTP downloader with four link resolvers: MediaFire, GitHub releases, MixMods article pages, and LibertyCity file pages. Each resolver takes a page URL and returns the direct download URL.

`src/extractor.py` – archive extraction (.zip via `stdlib`, .7z via `py7zr`, .rar via `rarfile`). Also implements `merge_into_sa_root()` which copies extracted files into the destination, overwriting existing files but never deleting extras.

`src/backup.py` – backs up original SA files to a timestamped .zip in the shared cache before mods are applied. Used by the backup stage.

`src/gamecopyworld.py` – scrapes `GameCopyWorld's` GTA SA page for NO-CD / Fixed EXE patches. Picks the HOODLUM v1.0 [ALL] No-CD/Fixed EXE as the recommended patch for downgrading Steam v3.0 or SecuROM exes.

`src/installer_stages.py` – the install pipeline. Five stages in order: `detect_version` → `copy_sa` → `apply_nocd` → `backup` → `install_mods`. Each stage takes an `InstallContext` and a progress callback. The source SA folder is NEVER modified – everything happens in the destination.

`src/ui/theme.py` – the 80s VCS+LCS+Ryder sunset theme. Registers the Pricedown font, paints the splash image background (anchored to bottom-right so the mod's watermark is always visible), and defines the dark green QSS stylesheet.

`src/ui/wizard.py` – the `QWizard` subclass. Wires together 9 pages: `welcome` → `mod_source` → `source_sa` → `destination` → `downgrade` → `backup` → `prereqs` → `install` → `complete`. Repaints the background whenever the page changes.

2. Data Flow

When the user clicks 'Finish' on the wizard, the `InstallPage` reads all the collected wizard properties (`source_sa_root`, `dest_sa_root`, `have_local_mods`, `archives_folder`, `needs_downgrade`, `nocd_patch_path`, `enabled_mod_ids`, `mod_sources`) and constructs an `InstallContext`. The context is passed to `installer_stages.run_full_install()` which runs the five stages sequentially on a worker thread.

Each stage reports progress via a callback that emits Qt signals (`log`, `progress`, `finished`) back to the UI thread. This keeps the wizard responsive while the install runs. The worker thread is a daemon, so it dies if

the user closes the wizard mid-install.

The mod install order is determined by the `install_order` field on each `ModSource`. Lower numbers run first. Currently: CLEO 5 (#10), CLEO+ (#20), NewOpcodes (#30), GTA SAS 1987 main mod (#100). Optional mods that the user unticks are skipped. The main mod is always installed.

3. Adding a New Mod Source

To add a new downloadable mod to the installer, follow these steps:

Step 1. Add a new `ModSource` entry to `src/config.py`. Pick a unique id, set `install_order` to control when it runs, and set the appropriate resolver flag (`is_mediafire`, `is_github_release`, `is_article_page`, or `is_libertycity`).

Step 2. If the mod's URL is on a new host that isn't covered by the existing resolvers, add a new resolver function to `src/downloader.py` following the same pattern as `resolve_mediafire()` or `resolve_github_release()`. Hook it into the `download()` function's resolver chain.

Step 3. If the mod should be auto-discovered from the official site (`gtasas.netlify.app`), add a URL pattern to the `_classify_url()` function in `src/scrapper.py` so the scraper can match the new mod's URL in the JS bundle.

Step 4. Test by running the wizard and verifying the mod appears on the Prereqs page. Tick it and run a full install to confirm the download + extract + merge works end-to-end.

4. Adding a New Wizard Page

To add a new page to the wizard:

Step 1. Create a new file in `src/ui/` (e.g. `my_new_page.py`). Subclass `QWizardPage`. Set a `splash_image_name` class attribute pointing at a PNG in `src/ui/splash/`. Implement `initializePage()`, `validatePage()`, and `nextId()` as needed.

Step 2. Add a new `PAGE_ID` constant to `src/ui/wizard.py`. Register your page in `InstallerWizard.__init__` via `self.setPage(PAGE_ID, MyNewPage(self))`. Update the `nextId()` of the preceding page to point at your new page ID.

Step 3. If your page collects data the install pipeline needs, store it on the wizard via `self.wizard().setProperty('my_field', value)` in `validatePage()`. Read it back in `install_page.py` via `self.wizard().property('my_field')` and pass it into the `InstallContext`.

Step 4. Add a corresponding field to the `InstallContext` dataclass in `installer_stages.py` if needed, and use it in the appropriate stage.

5. Adding a New Known SA Exe Version

To add a new `gta_sa.exe` version to the hash detection table:

Step 1. Compute the SHA-1 of the exe. On Windows PowerShell: `Get-FileHash gta_sa.exe -Algorithm SHA1`. On Linux/macOS: `shasum -a 1 gta_sa.exe`.

Step 2. Add a new entry to `data/exe_hashes.json` with the following fields: `id` (unique slug), `label` (human-readable), `region`, `version_string`, `file_size_bytes`, `sha1` (lowercase hex), `mod_compatible` (bool), `needs_downgrade` (bool), `source`, `notes`.

Step 3. The wizard will now detect this version automatically on the Downgrade page. If `mod_compatible` is true, the wizard will skip the NO-CD step. If false, it will offer the GCW downgrade flow.

6. Building the Standalone .exe

To produce a single-file Windows .exe that needs no Python install on the target machine:

Step 1. Install Python 3.10+ and the project dependencies: `pip install -r requirements.txt` and `pip install pyinstaller>=6.0`.

Step 2. Run `build_portable.bat` (or `pyinstaller installer.spec` directly). The spec file bundles the `data/`, `fonts/`, and `src/ui/splash/` directories into the .exe via the `--add-data` flag.

Step 3. Output appears in `dist/GTA_SAS_1987_Installer_Portable/`. The .exe is fully self-contained – copy it to any Windows 10/11 machine and double-click to run.

Note on .rar extraction: The bundled .exe needs 7-Zip or WinRAR installed on the target machine for .rar extraction (the rarfile library shells out to unrar.exe or 7z.exe). .zip and .7z work out of the box. Common install paths (C:\Program Files\7-Zip\7z.exe, C:\Program Files\WinRAR\unrar.exe) are auto-detected.

7. Customising the Theme

The theme lives entirely in `src/ui/theme.py`. The `COLOR_*` constants at the top define the VCS dark green palette. Change them and the whole wizard updates. The `QSS` variable at the bottom is the Qt stylesheet — edit it to change button shapes, border colors, font sizes, etc.

Splash images live in `src/ui/splash/`. Each `QWizardPage` subclass has a `splash_image_name` class attribute matching a filename in that folder. To use a different image per page, just replace the PNG (keep the same filename) or change the `splash_image_name` attribute and add a new PNG.

The splash image is rendered with bottom-right anchoring — the bottom-right corner of the image aligns with the bottom-right corner of the wizard window. This ensures any watermark in the bottom-right of the source image is always visible. The rest of the image fills up and to the left, then a dark green tint (alpha 180) is layered over so text stays legible.

8. Testing Your Changes

There is no formal test suite (yet). The recommended testing workflow is:

1. **Syntax check:** `python -m py_compile installer.py src/*.py src/ui/*.py` — catches typos and import errors.
2. **Offscreen render:** set `QT_QPA_PLATFORM=offscreen` and run the wizard. This verifies all pages instantiate and the theme paints without a display.
3. **Scraper smoke test:** run `python -c "from src import scraper; print(scraper.resolve_mod_sources())"` to verify the live site scrape still works.
4. **End-to-end on Windows:** run the full wizard against a real (or fake) SA install folder. The fake-folder test pattern is documented in the worklog — create a temp folder with a tiny fake `gta_sa.exe` and verify the copy stage works.

9. Licensing Your Fork

The installer code itself is intended to be released under a permissive open-source license (MIT or Apache 2.0 are recommended). However, you must respect the licenses of all bundled dependencies:

- **PySide6 (Qt6)** is LGPL v3 — free for commercial use with no copyleft requirement on your own code, as long as you dynamically link PySide6 (which Python does by default). This is more permissive than PyQt5's GPL.
- **Pricedown BI font** is free for commercial use under the Typodermic Fonts license. Keep the `FONT_LICENSE.html` and `Typodermic_EULA.pdf` files in your fork's `fonts/` directory.
- **The mod itself** is the property of its authors. Do not redistribute the mod archive — your fork should only download it from the official MediaFire link at install time, exactly as the current installer does.
- **NO-CD patches** from GameCopyWorld are for use with legally-purchased games only. Your fork should include a clear disclaimer to this effect.

10. Contributing Back

If you add a feature that would benefit other users (new mod source, new resolver, better detection, etc.), please consider opening a pull request against the upstream repository. Include a clear description of the change, the testing you did, and any new files you added.

Particularly valuable contributions: (1) real SHA-1 hashes for additional SA exe builds (German, French, Italian, Spanish, Russian, etc.) to expand `data/exe_hashes.json`; (2) additional mod sources beyond CLEO 5 / CLEO+ / NewOpcodes; (3) better fallback resolvers when Cloudflare blocks MixMods; (4) a formal test suite.

